in our glass garden

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/65585665.

Rating:	Mature
Archive Warning:	Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings
Category:	M/M
Fandom:	崩坏：星穹铁道 | Honkai: Star Rail (Video Game)
Relationship:	Mydei/Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)
Characters:	Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail)
Additional Tags:	Established Relationship, Written Before 3.3 Update (Honkai: Star Rail), Angst, Mild Sexual Content, Top Phainon/Bottom Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail), Hurt No Comfort, Unreliable Narrator
Language:	English
Stats:	Published: 2025-05-15 Words: 2,275 Chapters: 1/1

in our glass garden

by moongallery

Summary

Phainon makes a home in his thoughts. There, Mydei is with him.

Notes

i blacked out and wrote this little something something... i was supposed to finish something for mermay and got slapped with this instead. man

See the end of the work for more notes

- Translation into 中文-普通话 國語 available: 【授翻/厄敌】in our glass garden 在我们的琉璃园中 by kubicphaidei

The wheat fields shine in the setting sun. It's been a while since he last saw such a sight—of stalks rippling like an ocean of gold as it swayed with the wind, and a light willing to rest to make way for the stars.

In this world, the Sky is selfless. And though there is darkness, it does not bring about destruction. This place is home, but not quite. A quietness that bears comfort and yet still belies the lingering memories of anguish and loss.

Such is a home only in name. A beginning he ought to never have returned to. And yet, here he is, and here he stays.

Waiting.

Today, he is alone. Some days he is not. He misses the company that should be here at any moment now; the telltale scent of conflict he could smell, mired in sweetness only distinct to him, and the footfalls against the earth he'd created that is constant in its approach.

In this world, he feels everything. This is *his* world after all. And though he'd loathe to pick his favorites, there is only one that could monopolize his attention so selfishly. And he *allows* for it willingly.

Now, he situates himself against a tree, still as the wind is not, and tries to appear not so eager regardless of how his fingers twitch in anticipation.

Anticipation to be held, perhaps. In warmth, and a steadiness that drowns away the uncertain. A touch gentle enough to make him ache, firm enough to ground him. And now he hears the sound of footsteps drawing ever so nearer, the rustle of wheat against flowing crimson cloak.

Strife shouldn't look so magnificent in the eyes of the World.

But it does. *He* does. Always have been. And if it were only up to the Bearer of all of things, he'd allow a bringer of Calamity to engulf every inch of untainted crust if only to feel it forever. If only to etch *his* existence forever upon him.

"Mydeimos, you've come."

Eyes of gold rival that of the view behind him, of setting sun and wheat fields—of *home*. Eclipsing the old with the new one.

"Only because you keep waiting."

Phainon smiles. "Is it really that, or perhaps you also wished to see me?"

Though Strife is known to stir conflict, it's embodiment does not argue and maintains his silence, sentiments opted to be kept in secret. But Phainon knew Mydei well enough—learned him thoroughly in every opportunity granted to him. Whether it had been in the past life, in this life, or even the next.

Phainon could know nothing, he could live a fool. But he would never allow himself ignorance when it comes to his beloved. In this moment, words though unspoken are the words clearly understood. He can see it in the glimmer of those eyes of clear gold, in the slight twitch of lips, lashes fluttering. A gaze soft enough to be anything but reluctant admittance.

No use to wallow in doubt. Phainon has had a lifetime of that already. Mydei wouldn't be here if he didn't want to see him. And Phainon would've sought him out instead of waiting underneath the shade of a tree as if their meeting was predestined.

"You stand so far away."

"I don't wish to sully your perfection."

Phainon laughs, carefree. He hadn't done so in a long time, the action only brought upon by such blatant sarcasm. "I'll let you sully me anytime."

"And have the rest of the world pay for your carelessness?" Mydei asks, an eyebrow raised. "You've changed, and not in the best ways."

"I haven't," Phainon tells him. "Godhood simply made me honest."

A resigned huff resounds mingling with the whistle of the wind. Once again, Mydei does not result in a retort. Or something rather affectionately scathing. Instead, he occupies the empty space beside Phainon and leans against him, a welcome weight.

"Is this better?"

"I've had you much closer," Phainon says quietly, guileless. "But I suppose this would suffice for now."

Mydei makes a disgruntled sound, unsatisfied with the answer. "*For now?*"

Phainon shows an open palm. Mydei engulfs it with his own without much fanfare. Almost like a habit at this point with how their fingers slot together as if their separation was not even meant to be written alongside the fate of this world.

As the sun sets and the night blows a cold breeze, Phainon could only feel warmth. He has so much to say, perhaps to express a gratitude so profound the words are lodged in his throat still. If he were to speak, tears might spill instead of sentences uttered with grace.

Mydei deserves better than someone who could only offer emotions uncontrolled. Even if sincerity had never been a problem with either of them, Phainon would at least like to convey it with some semblance of dignity, just as Mydei had always done.

"What's on your mind?"

A question asked often enough that Phainon almost slips with an answer ingrained in memory. It is a well-crafted lie, perhaps, for Phainon could never find the true answer for it, of what *should* be on the forefront of his mind.

Duty. Someone who aims to please would know how to appease a crowd who doubts. Not even a philosopher would resort to an answer so vague.

"The future," says the liar.

"Nothing," says the liar again, when he's not in the mood to make up excuses.

"You," says Phainon, to an audience of one who could see through the disguise as if it's made of the thinnest of fabrics, sheer and see-through. "I think of *you*, Mydei."

Godhood has indeed made him honest.

He'd only ever left such an answer to rot in his mind, no amount of coaxing could ever make him say it. Not like Mydei is proficient in such gentle tactics. And Phainon likes that Mydei treats him as if he were tough even when he isn't.

Because it makes him believe that he is.

"Don't think so much of me," Mydei tells him. He doesn't flounder for words after hearing a declaration that would have flustered others, and his hold on Phainon's hand remains steady. "I'm here now. Make me exist in the present, and not only within the confines of your mind."

Phainon stares deeply into those twin pools of gold. Obedience comes easy to someone who's only lived for others his entire life. And so he vanquishes all thoughts, and pulls Mydei in for a kiss, cradling his beloved with a hand not held.

No matter how many times they've done this, it never fails to always feel like the first time. The fear of it being the last haunts Phainon far more than the nightmares that plague his dreams.

He kisses with no regrets left to spare. And if there's any during times they are most abundant, Phainon would simply hold Mydei again. It is as if Mydei is capable of cleansing away any remnants of filth that lingers in the very marrow of his existence.

The touch of Strife does not bring about the promised conflict and pain, no. For Phainon, it eases him of it. The burden of the World he carries becomes foreign for when it is Mydei that he holds, only then is he awashed with relief. An act, for once, that is not mired in forced responsibility, but of something far more willful.

As he lays Mydei on the ground of a land he held dominion over, he knew more than anyone that it is Mydei who held dominion over him.

Beautiful, Phainon wanted to say. Eyes selfish in the way they take in the sight before him—of hair the color of spun gold dipped in crimson, of tanned skin mired in glowing scarlet, of wet lips slightly parted in a silent question.

The sight of Mydei never fails to tug at his heart, insistent, a reminder that perhaps there is purpose in existing after all if only to behold such magnificence that shines brighter than any dawn hoping to rise from the horizon.

Though the sun has fully set and the stars have made itselves witness to the rare union of Strife and the World, Phainon finds that the darkness brought on by night is trivial.

It is temporary. He'd never mourn the loss when Mydei's existence alone brings Phainon a light mired in permanence. As long as he keeps it, as long as Mydei lets himself be kept. To be held so gently after the harshness of endless war, for the lingering pain of cut flesh and flowing blood to be eased with whispered promises of a future without it.

In the now, as Phainon strips them both—slides away the marks of their significance, their prestige, until only their very essence remains and godhood simmers dully beneath heated flesh to make way for their once-humanity—only then do they allow themselves to be free.

Phainon of his doubts. Mydei of war and death.

The dirt brings no comfort against bare skin, and the roots of the tree protruding from the ground digs against muscles and bone with far less comfort.

But Phainon minds not, and neither does Mydei, who clings to him tightly as he brings them both higher. He creates a world and bears it, and with Mydei so close, he allows himself to create another one with just them in it.

The world meant for others is selfless in its making. The world meant for *them*, however, is stark in its contrast, meant to devour for the sake of devouring, to consume what is there to be consumed and more.

"Mydeimos," Phainon whispers against lips open and spilling gasps. He swallows them all with a kiss, scoops Mydei up just to have him ever so closer than what is physically possible. Because he's desperate. "*Mydei*."

Fingers trace a familiar path down the ridges of the spine arched in bliss, and presses down against a spot that counts as the tenth. A weakness of pain, and a weakness of pleasure.

Mydei spills between their bodies with a muted shout, shivers when Phainon answers his release with one of his own, filling him generously. And though their embrace had ceased in its grappling, they both knew better than anyone that it was far from being the end of it.

The wind drowns the sound of debauchery unbefitting of gods enlightened. But this is a world that belongs to *them*. Debauchery and worship could be interchanged if they so desired, and no one would dare question it.

A lone moment of surrender, neither of them knew when they would let themselves feel this much again. In light of their divinity, humanity had already slipped away. *This* act is simply a product of remembrance, for their bodies knew how to come together far more than how it knew to exist alone.

In this world, Phainon creates a glass garden. In this world, Mydei shares the burden of godhood with him. And as he lays Mydei to rest beside him, eyes closed in slumber and body thrumming with needs satiated, Phainon allows himself to simply *be*.

The stars in the sky are ever so unchanging, he wouldn't have known the difference otherwise; the worlds he's created always have them for they are all he knew.

As the night deepens, Phainon wonders when the sun would rise. If it would ever do. And as the doubts begin to settle in once again, the warmth that kept them at bay slowly fades away. With how much he's indulged himself with Mydei's presence, one would expect that he would at least cease with the longing engraved in his very existence.

But he would never not long for a love meant to be only found once. And it is with Mydei that makes his heart sing with joy, or cry with sorrow, or thump with anger, or surge with lust. It is only with Mydei that he could *feel*.

The glass garden shatters with this revelation. Though the stars in the sky remain the same, the world doesn't.

In this world he once bore, he is alone. In this world he once bore, there is only suffering. In this world he once bore, he can never feel again.

There's no warmth beside him. Mydei is long gone, but the night persists. And even if Mydei had asked to exist in the present instead of in the confines of his own mind, it is not the mere act of disobedience that makes it impossible.

For the present is dark and ruinous. And Phainon's mind remains stuck in the past, or perhaps a present of what could have been, or a future most desired.

The world he bears in his mind is where Mydei exists. And there shall Mydei remain. He would not call it a memory, for he would never let Mydei exist in a time long gone, pulling him along to whichever part of the bygone world he goes.

Here, Mydei continues to share his burdens with him. And here, [redacted]'s faith in the once bearer of Strife becomes unshaking and unchanging as the night sky.

For it is only true faith to believe without seeing.

The wheat fields are barren, and the sun would dare not rise. In this world, there is only loss. [redacted] closes his eyes, and once again creates a world of setting suns and brilliant gold.

Mydei speaks. And it is Phainon who listens.

I'm here now. Make me exist in the present, and not only within the confines of your mind.

End Notes

thank you so much for reading!! <3 i hope you like this little something something i wrote on a whim hehe

my twitter & bluesky if you wanna drop by and say hi

Works inspired by this one

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!